ENT-164 · Intro to Making

Tufts University | Derby Entrepreneurship Center at Tufts

CLASS 8 · WEEK 8 · FALL 2026

Team Retrospective

Race day ends with a conversation. Look back on the build with your team, decide what to keep, and leave with actions you will use on the next project.

Thu, Oct 29 | JCC 301 / Nolop | Post-its and a pen | After the race



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A retrospective is a team meeting

You hold it at the end of a project or a phase. Everyone looks at what happened and agrees on what to change. It is the last step of the build, not an extra one.

01

What went well?

Name the successes and the strengths behind them, so the team keeps doing those on purpose.

02

What could be improved?

Name what cost you time, parts, or runs. A problem you can describe is a problem you can plan around.

03

What have we learned?

Write the lesson in a sentence you would pass to the next team.

Six steps, one conversation

Write first, decide as a team, and finish with something you can hand in.

1

Write

Three or more post-its per category, one idea on each.

2

Group

Cluster the similar ones and name each cluster.

3

Vote

Dot stickers on the items that matter most.

4

Discuss

One or two top items per category. Talk about why.

5

Act

Turn the discussion into actions with names on them.

6

Document

Write it up and hand it in with the Robo Challenge.

WHY THIS ORDER

Write before you talk. Ideas from the quietest person land in the pile first, before the loudest story sets the agenda.

Quiet time first

Five to ten minutes each, alone, before anyone speaks.

THE RULES

How to write

- → Three or more items per category
- → One item per post-it
- → Be specific. Name the moment, not the mood
- → No talking yet. This is quiet time

THE THREE PILES

One category each

- → What went well?
- → What could be improved?
- → What have we learned?

SPECIFIC **“The left wheel spun backwards when we pushed up”** teaches something. “The wiring was confusing” does not.

Sort the pile, then pick the few

Grouping turns a board of post-its into a handful of themes. Voting tells you which themes the whole team cares about.

STEP 2

Group similar items

- → Everyone puts their post-its on one shared board
- → Read the whole board before moving anything
- → Move related items into clusters
- → Give each cluster a short theme name

STEP 3

Vote on the top items

- → Each person gets a set of dot stickers
- → Put dots on the items you think matter most
- → Spread your dots, or spend them all on one item
- → Count the dots. The top items go to the discussion

WHY DOTS **A dot is a quiet vote.** Everyone's view lands on the board, without anyone needing to win the room.

Talk about why, then decide what changes

The discussion explains the list. The action items are the only part that reaches the next build.

04

Discuss the top items

Take the one or two most-voted items in each category. Ask why it happened, not only what happened. Agree on the cause, or say clearly that you see it differently.

05

Define actions

Each action names what changes and who owns it. Put a name and a date next to it, so the next build can start with it.

TEST AN ACTION

Could a teammate start it without asking you? If not, it is still a wish. Good: “Test the robot on the competition surface at least twice.” Not: “Do more testing.”

Write it up and hand it in

One shared document, written while the discussion is fresh. It is what your team reads before the next project starts.

THE DOCUMENT

What goes in it

- → The top-voted items from each category
- → Brief notes on the discussion for each one
- → Action items with names and dates where you can
- → Anything else the team wants to keep

HAND IT IN

With the Robo Challenge

- → Put every teammate’s name at the top
- → Submit the document, or a link to it, before you leave
- → Use the Robo Challenge assignment on Canvas

TWO DOCUMENTS

The team document is not the individual reflection. The milestone reflection is yours alone, due next week at **go.tufts.edu/reflect**.

YOUR TURN

Grab a pen and start with the good

Quiet writing first. Three post-its minimum in each category, one item per post-it.

What went well?

Name the wins and the strengths behind them.

What could be improved?

Name what cost you time, parts, or runs.

What have we learned?

Write the lesson you would pass on.

BEFORE YOU GO

Questions?

Then finish the document and submit it with the Robo Challenge. The individual milestone reflection is due next week, at go.tufts.edu/reflect.

Next class · Thu, Nov 5: the final project begins with a concept pitch.

WHERE TO FIND US

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go.tufts.edu/meet_tvdv

Email
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Course materials
tuftsmaker.github.io/ENT-164